

1.

A. Anne's plate was empty again, but this time she really couldn't eat any more.
Why couldn't Anne eat any more?

B. The small, flightless bird makes its nest in the ground.
Why does the bird make its nest in the ground?

C. The prairie dog is a kind of squirrel which makes a barking noise.
Why's it called a prairie dog?

THE WORST STUDENT

I knew what mum was holding in her hand. She didn't smile, nor did she take her eyes off me as I walked up the path. "What do you call this?" she bellowed. "Poor marks is one thing, but I never dreamed a child of mine would ever be described as 'the worst student I have ever taught!'"

a. What was mum holding in her hand?

b. Was mum pleased? How do you know that?

c. Who described the child as 'the worst student' have ever taught'?

TRUNKIE

The latest favourite toy craze has been turned into a TV cartoon series.

For those who haven't heard yet, Trunkie is a soft, cuddly, lovable elephant that comes with its own adoption papers much like another high profile soft toy of a few years ago. Like that doll, children can give their elephant its own official name.

Trunkie the cartoon series began its run on TV yesterday at a time which was sure to capture the attention of children as they settled down in front of TV after arriving home from school.

The storyline of the TV show is very simple: the cute, orphaned baby elephant, Trunkie, goes in search of someone to take care of him. Along the way he meets all sorts of difficulties, including some mean nasties called the Zarbos, who for reasons of their own, seem determined to stop anyone from taking care of the little elephant. Of course, Trunkie is always rescued at the last moment by some kind-hearted and brave children before heading off into more adventures. Trunkie owners can see what might have happened to their elephant if they had not adopted it.

The stories are predictable, but this colourful cartoon series is less violent than many of the programmes shown in this high rating time slot.

1. What time of the day is the cartoon Trunkie on TV?
2. Are the Zarbos the only difficulties for Trunkie? How do you know that?
3. Does the writer know why the Zarbos are so hostile to Trunkie? How do you know that?
4. Do the Zarbos succeed in their mission? How do you know that?
5. What does the writer think of many of the TV programmes that are on at the same time of the day as Trunkie?